

أَعُوذُ بِاللَّهِ مِنَ الشَّيْطَانِ الرَّجِيمِ

بِسْمِ اللَّهِ الرَّحْمَنِ الرَّحِيمِ

Lisan ul Quran — Lecture 12

The I'raab of Tathniyah and Jam' Salim nouns

1. Recognising the Ism, and I'raab

#	Mark	Examples
1	al- at the beginning	الْحَمْدُ ، الْجِبَالُ ، الْكَوْنُ
2	A round ة at the end	شَفَاعَةٌ ، جَنَّةٌ ، كَلِمَةٌ
3	Tanween at the end	قَوْلٌ ، قَوْلًا ، قَوْلِ

I'raab is the most important characteristic of Arabic and belongs to Arabic alone. Its literal meaning is to make Arabic. The change that occurs in the state or shape of a noun without any change in meaning is called a change of *I'raab*. Knowing the *I'raab* of a noun tells us what role it plays in the sentence, what it has come as, and why its state is changing.

2. The three states of the Ism by I'raab

- *Halat ur Raf'* — a noun in this state is called *Marfoo'*.
- *Halat un Nasb* — a noun in this state is called *Mansoob*.
- *Halat ul Jarr* — a noun in this state is called *Majroor*.

The I'raab of singular and Jam' Mukassar nouns

Singular and *Jam' Mukassar* nouns, whether masculine or feminine, are *Marfoo'* with two pesh, *Mansoob* with two zabar and *Majroor* with two zer. When اَلْ is placed at their beginning, a single pesh replaces the two pesh, a single zabar the two zabar, and a single zer the two zer.

Noun	Marfoo'	Mansoob	Majroor	Marfoo' (al-)	Mansoob (al-)	Majroor (al-)
Singular	رَجُلٌ	رَجُلًا	رَجُلِ	الرَّجُلُ	الرَّجُلَ	الرَّجُلِ
Jam' Mukassar	رِجَالٌ	رِجَالًا	رِجَالِ	الرِّجَالُ	الرِّجَالَ	الرِّجَالِ

Ghayr Munsarif nouns: Some singular and *Jam' Mukassar* nouns take no *Tanween* at the end and are *Majroor* with a zabar. These are called *Ghayr Munsarif*. When اَلْ enters them, however, they do take a kasrah in the state of *jarr*.

3. I'raab bil Harakah and I'raab bil Harf

There are two ways of showing the *I'raab* of a noun, and the whole of this lecture rests on that division.

Method	Definition	In which nouns
I'raab bil Harakah	Showing the I'raab through the harakaat found at the end of the noun	Singular masculine and feminine, Jam' Mukassar, and Jam' Salim Mu'annath
I'raab bil Harf	Showing the I'raab through the letters found at the end of the noun	Tathniyah (masculine and feminine), Jam' Salim Mudhakkar, and the Asma' Sittah

This is why the *I'raab* of a *Tathniyah* appears with an alif in the state of *raf'* and with a yaa' in *nasb* and *jarr*, while that of the *Jam' Salim Mudhakkar* appears with a waw in *raf'* and a yaa' in *nasb* and *jarr*.

4. The I'raab of Tathniyah nouns

The method of forming the *Tathniyah* is one and the same for masculine and feminine, whether the noun is an adjective or not. Every noun can form its *Tathniyah* in two ways.

Rule: *Tathniyah* nouns, masculine and feminine alike, are *Marfoo'* with the sound aani, and *Mansoob* and *Majroor* with the sound ayni.

Singular	Working	Marfoo'	Mansoob and Majroor
وَلَدٌ	وَلَدٌ + اِنْ / يَنْ	وَلَدَانِ	وَلَدَيْنِ
بِنْتُ	بِنْتُ + اِنْ / يَنْ	بِنْتَانِ	بِنْتَيْنِ

Gender	Marfoo'	Mansoob	Majroor
Mudhakkar	طَالِبَانِ	طَالِبَيْنِ	طَالِبَيْنِ
Mudhakkar	وَلَدَانِ	وَلَدَيْنِ	وَلَدَيْنِ

Gender	Marfoo'	Mansoob	Majroor
Mudhakkar	مُؤْمِنَانِ	مُؤْمِنَيْنِ	مُؤْمِنَيْنِ
Mu'annath	بِنْتَانِ	بِنْتَيْنِ	بِنْتَيْنِ
Mu'annath	طَالِبَتَانِ	طَالِبَتَيْنِ	طَالِبَتَيْنِ
Mu'annath	جَنَّتَانِ	جَنَّتَيْنِ	جَنَّتَيْنِ

A Qur'anic example

اَلَمْ نَجْعَلْ لَهُ عَيْنَيْنِ ﴿٨﴾ وَلِسَانًا وَشَفَتَيْنِ ﴿٩﴾ وَهَدَيْنَاهُ النَّجْدَيْنِ ﴿١٠﴾

(Surah al-Balad: 8 to 10)

- عَيْنَيْنِ — *Tathniyah, Mu'annath, Mansoob or Majroor*
- شَفَتَيْنِ — *Tathniyah, Mu'annath, Mansoob or Majroor*
- النَّجْدَيْنِ — *Tathniyah, Mudhakkar, Mansoob or Majroor*

5. The I'raab of Jam' Salim Mudhakkar nouns

A singular masculine noun can form its *Jam' Salim* in two ways. Giving the last letter a dammah and adding وُنْ produces the sound oona at the end; and giving it a kasrah and adding يْنِ produces the sound eena.

Rule: *Jam' Salim Mudhakkar* nouns are *Marfoo'* with the sound oona, and *Mansoob* and *Majroor* with the sound eena.

Singular	Marfoo'	Mansoob	Majroor
مُسْلِم	مُسْلِمُونَ	مُسْلِمِينَ	مُسْلِمِينَ
كَافِر	كَافِرُونَ	كَافِرِينَ	كَافِرِينَ

Qur'anic examples

اَلَّا تَعْلَمُوْا عَلٰٓى وَاَثُوْبِيْ مُسْلِمِيْنَ

(Surah an-Naml: 31) مُسْلِمِيْنَ — Mansoob

يَا أَيُّهَا الَّذِينَ آمَنُوا اتَّقُوا اللَّهَ حَقَّ تَقَاتِهِ وَلَا تَمُوتُنَّ إِلَّا وَأَنتُمْ مُسْلِمُونَ

(Surah Al 'Imran: 102) — Marfoo'

قَدْ سَأَلَهَا قَوْمٌ مِّن قَبْلِكُم ثُمَّ أَصْبَحُوا بِهَا كَافِرِينَ

(Surah al-Ma'idah: 102) — Mansoob

6. The I'raab of Jam' Salim Mu'annath nouns

For feminine nouns ending in a round ة, the round ة is removed and ات put in its place, producing the sound aat at the end.

Rule: *Jam' Salim Mu'annath* nouns are *Marfoo'* with the sound aatun, and *Mansoob* and *Majroor* with the sound aatin.

Noun	Marfoo'	Mansoob	Majroor
مُسْلِمَات	مُسْلِمَاتُ	مُسْلِمَاتٍ	مُسْلِمَاتٍ
مُؤْمِنَات	مُؤْمِنَاتُ	مُؤْمِنَاتٍ	مُؤْمِنَاتٍ
قَانِنَات	قَانِنَاتُ	قَانِنَاتٍ	قَانِنَاتٍ
عَابِدَات	عَابِدَاتُ	عَابِدَاتٍ	عَابِدَاتٍ
سَائِحَات	سَائِحَاتُ	سَائِحَاتٍ	سَائِحَاتٍ

A special point: Although the *I'raab* of the *Jam' Salim Mu'annath* does come through *harakaat*, there is one curious thing about it: **in the state of nasb a kasrah comes instead of a fathah**. A kasrah thus stands in for the fathah, which is why it is counted as one form of *I'raab Far'i*.

Qur'anic examples

عَسَىٰ رَبُّهُ إِنْ طَلَّقَكُنَّ أَنْ يُبَدِّلَهُ أَزْوَاجًا خَيْرًا مِّنْكَنَّ مُسْلِمَاتٍ مُُّؤْمِنَاتٍ قَنَاطٍ تَائِبَاتٍ عِبَدَاتٍ سَائِحَاتٍ ثَيِّبَاتٍ وَأَبْكَارًا

(Surah at-Tahrim: 5)

Seven words in this verse are *Jam' Salim Mu'annath*, all ending in the sound aatin — that is, all *Mansoob*.

وَرَفَعَ بَعْضَهُمْ دَرَجَاتٍ ۖ وَآتَيْنَا عِيسَى ابْنَ مَرْيَمَ الْبَيِّنَاتِ وَأَيَّدْنَاهُ بِرُوحِ الْقُدُسِ

(part of Surah al-Baqarah: 253)

- دَرَجَتٍ — *Jam' Salim, Mu'annath, Mansoob* or *Majroor, Nakirah*
- أَلْبَيْتِ — *Jam' Salim, Mu'annath, Mansoob* or *Majroor, Ma'rifah*
- أَلْبَيْتُ — *Jam' Salim, Mu'annath, Marfoo', Ma'rifah* (in the following part of the same verse)

7. The Asma' Sittah Mukabbarah

Besides the *Tathniyah* and the *Jam' Salim Mudhakkar*, there is a third class of *I'raab bil Harf*. Six particular Arabic nouns show their *I'raab* through letters rather than through the vowels used by ordinary words. They are: أَب ، أَخ ، حَم ، فُو ، ذُو ، هَن .

Rule: In the state of *raf'* a waw comes with them (as in أَبُوهُمْ), in *nasb* an alif (as in أَبَاهُمْ), and in *jarr* a yaa' (as in أَيُّكُمْ).

Halat ur Raf' — waw	Halat un Nasb — alif	Halat ul Jarr — yaa'
أَبُوكَ	أَبَاكَ	أَيُّكَ
جَاءَ أَبُوكَ	رَأَيْتُ أَبَاكَ	مَرَرْتُ بِأَيُّكَ

Four conditions for I'raab bil Harf

- These nouns must be *Mudaf*, that is, not standing alone but related to another noun or pronoun, as in أَبُوكَ.
- They must be *singular*. If they are dual or plural, their *I'raab* changes.
- They must be *mukabbarah*, that is, in their original form and not a diminutive. The *I'raab* of أَيُّ comes through vowels.
- They must **not be annexed to the yaa' ul mutakallim**. If they are, as in أَبِي (my father) or أَخِي (my brother), the *I'raab* becomes *muqaddar*, that is, hidden, and does not appear through letters.

The particular rules for Dhu and Fam

The word ذُو (possessor of) is only ever used as a *Mudaf*, so its *I'raab* is always through letters: ذُو in the state of *raf'*, ذَا الْقُرْبَى in *nasb*, and ذِي الْقُرْبَى in *jarr*.

As for the word فَم (mouth), its *I'raab* comes through letters only when the meem is dropped from its end and it is read as فُو. If the meem remains, the *I'raab* is expressed through ordinary vowels.

8. The dropping of the Nun ul I'raabi in Idafah

Nouns whose *I'raab* changes through letters are unaffected when اَلْ enters them. But when such nouns become *Mudaf* in a *Murakkab Idafi*, two significant changes occur.

The first change: In the *Tathniyah* and the *Jam' Mudhakkar Salim*, as soon as *idafah* occurs the Nun ul I'raabi drops from the end.

- يَدَانِ (two hands) → يَدَا أَبِي هَبٍ (the two hands of Abu Lahab)
- بَنُونَ (sons) → بَنُو إِسْرَءِيلَ (the sons of Israel)

The second change: So long as the *Asma' Sittah* are not *Mudaf*, their *I'raab* generally comes through vowels. But as soon as they become *Mudaf*, a waw, an alif or a yaa' is added to them, and it is that letter which shows their *I'raab*.

9. The CNG test for nouns

An easy method is used for identifying any noun while reading the Qur'an, called the **CNG Test**:

- C — Capacity, that is *wus'at*: whether the noun is *Ma'rifah* or *Nakirah*
- N — Number, that is *'adad*: whether it is *Wahid*, *Tathniyah* or *Jam'*
- G — Gender, that is *jins*: whether it is *Mudhakkar* or *Mu'annath*

Along with these three, the *I'raab* of the noun is stated as well. Analyse the verses below by this method.

Surah an-Nur, verse 26

الْحَيِّثُ لِلْحَيِّثِ وَالْحَيُّونَ لِلْحَيِّثِ ۚ وَالطَّيِّبُ لِلطَّيِّبِ وَالطَّيِّبُونَ لِلطَّيِّبِ ۚ أُولَٰئِكَ مُبَرَّءُونَ مِمَّا يَقُولُونَ ۚ لَهُمْ مَغْفِرَةٌ وَرِزْقٌ كَرِيمٌ

Word	'Adad	Jins	I'raab	Wus'at
الْحَيِّثُ	Jam' Salim	Mu'annath	Marfoo'	Ma'rifah
لِلْحَيِّثِ	Jam' Salim	Mudhakkar	Mansoob or Majroor	Ma'rifah
الْحَيُّونَ	Jam' Salim	Mudhakkar	Marfoo'	Ma'rifah

Word	'Adad	Jins	I'raab	Wus'at
لِلْحَيِّثِ	Jam' Salim	Mu'annath	Mansoob or Majroor	Ma'rifah
الطَّيِّبُ	Jam' Salim	Mu'annath	Marfoo'	Ma'rifah
لِلطَّيِّبِ	Jam' Salim	Mudhakkar	Mansoob or Majroor	Ma'rifah
الطَّيِّبُونَ	Jam' Salim	Mudhakkar	Marfoo'	Ma'rifah
لِلطَّيِّبِ	Jam' Salim	Mu'annath	Mansoob or Majroor	Ma'rifah
مُبرَّءُونَ	Jam' Salim	Mudhakkar	Marfoo'	Nakirah
مَغْفِرَةٌ	Wahid	Mu'annath	Marfoo'	Nakirah
رِزْقٌ	Wahid	Mudhakkar	Marfoo'	Nakirah
كَرِيمٌ	Wahid	Mudhakkar	Marfoo'	Nakirah

Surah al-Munafiqun, verse 1

إِذَا جَاءَكَ الْمُنَافِقُونَ قَالُوا نَشْهَدُ إِنَّكَ لَرَسُولُ اللَّهِ وَاللَّهُ يَعْلَمُ إِنَّكَ لَرَسُولُهُ وَاللَّهُ يَشْهَدُ إِنَّ الْمُنَافِقِينَ لَكَاذِبُونَ

Word	How it is recognised	Analysis
الْمُنَافِقُونَ	al- and the oona sound	Jam' Salim, Mudhakkar, Marfoo', Ma'rifah
اللَّهُ	al- and being a name	Wahid, Mudhakkar, Majroor, Ma'rifah
اللَّهُ	al- and being a name	Wahid, Mudhakkar, Marfoo', Ma'rifah
الْمُنَافِقِينَ	al- and the eena sound	Jam' Salim, Mudhakkar, Mansoob or Majroor, Ma'rifah
لَكَاذِبُونَ	the oona sound	Jam' Salim, Mudhakkar, Marfoo', Nakirah

10. An important question: why does La-Rasoolu have no Tanween?

There is a point worth pondering in this same verse. In لَرَسُولُ and لَرَسُولُهُ, the word Rasool is a singular noun carrying a single vowel. Yet Rasool is neither a *Ghayr Munsarif* noun, nor is the lam upon it the *Lam ut Ta'reef* — for the *Lam ut Ta'reef* is always silent, whereas here the lam carries a fathah. Why then is there no *Tanween*?

The answer: The reason is *idafah*. رَسُوْلُ اللهِ is a *Murakkab Idafi* in which رَسُوْلُ is the *Mudaf* and اللهُ the *Mudaf Ilayh*. Likewise in رَسُوْلُهُ the pronoun is the *Mudaf Ilayh*. And the rule of Arabic is that a *Mudaf* takes neither **Tanween** nor **alif lam**. This is why a single pesh has come here instead of two. The full detail of this will come in the lesson on the *Murakkab Idafi*.

Summary

1. The Ism has three outward marks: al- at the beginning, a round ى at the end, and Tanween at the end.
2. By I'raab a noun has three states: raf' (Marfoo'), nasb (Mansoob) and jarr (Majroor).
3. Singular and Jam' Mukassar nouns are Marfoo' with two pesh, Mansoob with two zabar and Majroor with two zer. With al- the doubled vowel becomes single.
4. Ghayr Munsarif nouns take no Tanween and are Majroor with a zabar, but with al- they do take a kasrah.
5. There are two ways of showing I'raab: I'raab bil Harakah and I'raab bil Harf.
6. I'raab bil Harakah belongs to the singular, the Jam' Mukassar and the Jam' Salim Mu'annath; I'raab bil Harf to the Tathniyah, the Jam' Salim Mudhakkar and the Asma' Sittah.
7. A Tathniyah is Marfoo' with the sound aani and Mansoob and Majroor with the sound ayni, in both genders.
8. A Jam' Salim Mudhakkar is Marfoo' with the sound oona and Mansoob and Majroor with the sound eena.
9. A Jam' Salim Mu'annath is Marfoo' with the sound aatun and Mansoob and Majroor with the sound aatin.
10. In the Jam' Salim Mu'annath a kasrah comes instead of a fathah in the state of nasb, which is why it is called a form of I'raab Far'i.
11. The Asma' Sittah are six: هُنَّ, هُنَّ, هُنَّ, هُنَّ, هُنَّ, هُنَّ. Their I'raab comes with a waw in raf', an alif in nasb and a yaa' in jarr.
12. Four conditions attach to the I'raab bil Harf of the Asma' Sittah: they must be Mudaf, singular, mukabbarah, and not annexed to the yaa' ul mutakallim.
13. هُنَّ is only ever used as a Mudaf, and the I'raab of هُنَّ comes through letters only when it is read as هُنَّ.
14. When a Tathniyah or a Jam' Mudhakkar Salim becomes Mudaf, its Nun ul I'raabi drops, as in هُنَّ إِسْرَافِيلَ and هُنَّ إِدَا أَبِي لَهَبٍ.
15. Nouns whose I'raab changes through letters are unaffected by the entry of al-.
16. The CNG test examines the wus'at, 'adad and jins of a noun, and its I'raab is stated along with them.
17. لِرَسُولٍ has no Tanween because it is a Mudaf, and a Mudaf takes neither Tanween nor alif lam.

Exercise

1. Define I'raab bil Harakah and I'raab bil Harf, and state which nouns fall under each.
2. Through which two sounds does the I'raab of a Tathniyah appear? Give two examples each of masculine and feminine.
3. Form the Tathniyah of the following in all three states: طَالِبٌ, جَنَّةٌ, مُؤْمِنٌ.

4. Take the three Tathniyah words from Surah al-Balad verses 8 to 10 and analyse each.
5. Write the method of forming the Jam' Salim Mudhakkar and its I'raab.
6. State the I'raab of the Jam' Salim Mudhakkar words in the following verses: وَأَتَوْنِي مُسْلِمِينَ and وَأَنْتُمْ مُسْلِمُونَ.
7. Write the I'raab of the Jam' Salim Mu'annath and state what is curious about it.
8. Take the seven Jam' Salim Mu'annath words from Surah at-Tahrim verse 5.
9. Which are the Asma' Sittah? Explain all three of their states through أَب.
10. Write all four conditions for the I'raab bil Harf of the Asma' Sittah.
11. State the particular rules governing فَم and ذُو.
12. What change occurs in the Tathniyah and the Jam' Mudhakkar Salim in idafah? Give two Qur'anic examples.
13. Write the three parts of the CNG test and analyse four words from Surah an-Nur verse 26.
14. Why does لِرَسُول have no Tanween? Give the reason along with the rule.

سُبْحَانَكَ اللَّهُمَّ وَبِحَمْدِكَ، أَشْهَدُ أَنْ لَا إِلَهَ إِلَّا أَنْتَ، أَسْتَغْفِرُكَ وَأَتُوبُ إِلَيْكَ

اللَّهُمَّ صَلِّ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا صَلَّيْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ

اللَّهُمَّ بَارِكْ عَلَى مُحَمَّدٍ وَعَلَى آلِ مُحَمَّدٍ كَمَا بَارَكْتَ عَلَى إِبْرَاهِيمَ وَعَلَى آلِ إِبْرَاهِيمَ إِنَّكَ حَمِيدٌ مَجِيدٌ